

KS3: Causes of the Great War

"How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?"

MASTERY PACK: COMPLETE UNIT

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 139 Crucial Questions



⚡ Interactive Leitner & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch 3-Box Spaced Flashcards (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

meoncross-history.netlify.app/units/great_war/mastery_pack_full.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

-  **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
-  **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
-  **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

-  **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
-  **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
-  **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	How many independent states existed in Central Europe before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which state was the most powerful among the German states before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Who became the Prime Minister of Prussia in 1862?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What was Bismarck's famous phrase for how Germany would be unified?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What did 'blood and iron' mean in Bismarck's approach?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Which three countries did Prussia defeat to unify Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
7	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War begin?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Where was the King of Prussia proclaimed the first German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
9	When was the German Empire officially created?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which valuable French territory did Germany seize in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What was the economic union created by Prussia in 1834 called?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Which major German-speaking power was deliberately excluded from the Zollverein?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What was the German term for the new German Empire?	☐	☐	☐	
14	How long did it take the Prussian army to crush Austria in 1866?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
15	Who was the first Emperor (Kaiser) of the newly unified Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
16	Why did Bismarck provoke a war with France in 1870?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which French Emperor was captured by the Prussian military?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What natural resources was Alsace-Lorraine rich in?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What long-term effect did the taking of Alsace-Lorraine have?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Why was the unification of Germany a shock to the balance of power in Europe?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Name two major powers in Europe in 1870.	☐	☐	☐	
22	What is an empire?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Why is having a strong army important for a country surrounded by others?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Define the term 'Balance of Power'.	☐	☐	☐	
25	Who was the Chancellor of Prussia that orchestrated the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
26	Which telegram did Bismarck edit to provoke France into war?	☐	☐	☐	
27	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War break out?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Which two provinces were taken from France in the peace settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Where was the German Empire proclaimed in 1871, humiliating the French?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What was the size of the war indemnity France was forced to pay?	☐	☐	☐	
31	Who became the new German Emperor in 1888 and dismissed Bismarck?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What secret treaty did Bismarck sign with Russia that Wilhelm II allowed to expire?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Which country allied with Russia in 1894 after Bismarck's dismissal?	☐	☐	☐	
34	What was Germany's greatest fear that drove its military planning?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
35	What was the name of the German military plan created to defeat France quickly?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Which French leader was captured at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What was the primary goal of Bismarck in defeating France?	☐	☐	☐	
38	Which French territory was annexed by Germany, creating lasting resentment?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Who was the Prussian King that was crowned German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
40	What event did Bismarck use to trick France into declaring war?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What happened to Napoleon III at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What treaty formally ended the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
43	Why did Bismarck fear a French alliance with Russia?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Where exactly was the new German Empire proclaimed?	☐	☐	☐	
45	What term describes the rapid colonization of Africa by European powers in the late 19th century?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Which German leader famously stated that Germany wanted its 'place in the sun'?	☐	☐	☐	
47	In which year did the First Moroccan Crisis occur?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What was the purpose of the 1884 Berlin Conference?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Which European power controlled the largest empire in Africa by 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Why did Kaiser Wilhelm II demand a 'place in the sun'?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What happened during the First Moroccan Crisis (1905)?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the main result of the Algeiras Conference (1906)?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What sparked the Second Moroccan Crisis (Agadir Crisis) in 1911?	☐	☐	☐	
54	How did the Agadir Crisis end?	☐	☐	☐	
55	What effect did the Moroccan Crises have on Anglo-French	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	relations?				
56	1. Who was the first Emperor of the newly unified Germany in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
57	2. Which brilliant Chancellor united the German states?	☐	☐	☐	
58	3. Which country was humiliatingly defeated in the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
59	4. What strategic border territory did Germany take in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
60	5. What is the French word for their desire for revenge?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	6. Explain how Bismarck used the Ems Telegram to trap France into a war.	☐	☐	☐	
62	7. Detail the two military advantages the Prussian army possessed.	☐	☐	☐	
63	8. Why was the location of the German Empire's proclamation so humiliating for France?	☐	☐	☐	
64	9. Why did Bismarck weave a complex web of secret alliances after 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
65	10. What was Bismarck's ultimate nightmare scenario?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What revolutionary British battleship was launched in 1906?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Which German Admiral was in charge of expanding the German Navy?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What policy dictated that the British Royal Navy must be as large as the next two largest navies combined?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Why was the HMS Dreadnought completely revolutionary?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What was the consequence of the Dreadnought's launch?	☐	☐	☐	
71	What was the German 'Risk Theory' proposed by Admiral Tirpitz?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What slogan did the British public chant in 1909 to demand more ships?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
73	Why did Britain feel so threatened by the German naval expansion?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What laws were passed in Germany to fund their massive naval buildup?	☐	☐	☐	
75	By 1914, who had won the naval race?	☐	☐	☐	
76	How did the naval race affect British foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	
77	1. What was the name of Kaiser Wilhelm II's aggressive foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	
78	2. Explain how Wilhelm II's actions during the Moroccan Crises backfired on Germany.	☐	☐	☐	
79	3. Why was the Franco-Russian Alliance a strategic disaster for Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
80	4. Evaluate how the 'Scramble for Africa' increased tensions in Europe.	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	5. Describe the impact of Britain abandoning its policy of 'Splendid Isolation'.	☐	☐	☐	
82	6. Evaluate the role of Wilhelm II's personality in destabilizing Europe.	☐	☐	☐	
83	7. Who dismissed Otto von Bismarck in 1890?	☐	☐	☐	
84	8. What strategic territory did Germany take from France in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
85	9. Why did Bismarck weave a complex web of secret alliances after 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
86	10. What was Bismarck's ultimate nightmare scenario?	☐	☐	☐	
87	Which three countries formed the Triple Entente in 1907?	☐	☐	☐	
88	Which country left the Triple Alliance and joined the Entente in 1915?	☐	☐	☐	
89	What was Britain's traditional foreign policy before forming alliances?	☐	☐	☐	
90	Which three countries made up the Triple Alliance of 1882?	☐	☐	☐	
91	Which three countries formed the Triple Entente by 1907?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What was a major flaw of the alliance system?	☐	☐	☐	
93	Why did Russia ally with France in 1894?	☐	☐	☐	
94	What was the 'Entente Cordiale' signed in 1904?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
95	Why did Britain finally decide to form alliances?	☐	☐	☐	
96	What does 'Weltpolitik' mean?	☐	☐	☐	
97	Which nation in the Triple Alliance was seen as the 'weak link'?	☐	☐	☐	
98	1. What revolutionary British battleship was launched in 1906?	☐	☐	☐	
99	2. What was the 'Two-Power Standard'?	☐	☐	☐	
100	3. Why did Germany feel it needed a massive high seas fleet?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	4. Explain how the invention of the Dreadnought ironically hurt British supremacy.	☐	☐	☐	
102	5. What was the popular British slogan chanted by the public in 1909?	☐	☐	☐	
103	6. Why did Britain feel their survival depended on massive naval supremacy?	☐	☐	☐	
104	7. How did the Anglo-German naval race make war more likely?	☐	☐	☐	
105	8. What was the name of Kaiser Wilhelm II's aggressive foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	
106	9. Explain how Wilhelm II's actions during the Moroccan Crises backfired on Germany.	☐	☐	☐	
107	10. Evaluate how the 'Scramble for Africa' increased tensions in Europe.	☐	☐	☐	
108	Who assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand?	☐	☐	☐	
109	What was the name of the Serbian nationalist group responsible for the assassination?	☐	☐	☐	
110	On what exact date was the Archduke assassinated?	☐	☐	☐	
111	Which empire had annexed Bosnia in 1908, angering Serbian nationalists?	☐	☐	☐	
112	Who was the heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne that visited Sarajevo?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
113	What terrorist group supplied the assassins with weapons?	☐	☐	☐	
114	What was the first, failed assassination attempt on the Archduke that morning?	☐	☐	☐	
115	Why was Gavrilo Princip standing outside Schiller's Delicatessen when the Archduke's car stopped?	☐	☐	☐	
116	What was the 'Blank Cheque'?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What happened on July 23, 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
118	Why did Britain declare war on Germany on August 4, 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
119	1. Which three countries made up the Triple Entente?	☐	☐	☐	
120	2. Which three countries made up the Triple Alliance?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
121	3. Explain the theoretical logic of how the alliance system was supposed to keep peace.	☐	☐	☐	
122	4. Why did the alliance system actually increase paranoia instead of security?	☐	☐	☐	
123	5. What military plan did Germany create to avoid a long two-front war?	☐	☐	☐	
124	6. Which neutral country did the Schlieffen Plan require invading?	☐	☐	☐	
125	7. What feeling of being surrounded by enemies haunted German planners?	☐	☐	☐	
126	8. What revolutionary British battleship was launched in 1906?	☐	☐	☐	
127	9. Explain how the invention of the Dreadnought ironically hurt British supremacy.	☐	☐	☐	
128	10. How did the Anglo-German naval race make war more likely?	☐	☐	☐	
129	What was the name of the Austro-Hungarian heir whose assassination on 28 June 1914 sparked the July Crisis?	☐	☐	☐	
130	Which Serbian nationalist secret society was Gavrilo Princip connected with during the Sarajevo assassination?	☐	☐	☐	
131	Which two major European alliance blocs confronted each other in 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
132	Which three nations made up the Triple Entente in 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
133	What unconditional promise of military support did Germany	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	give to Austria-Hungary on 5 July 1914?				
134	What German war plan, designed in 1905, aimed to defeat France in six weeks by invading through neutral Belgium before turning to face Russia?	☐	☐	☐	
135	What treaty signed in 1839 guaranteed Belgian neutrality and brought Britain into the war when Germany violated it?	☐	☐	☐	
136	Which prominent German historian published 'Griff nach der Weltmacht' (1961), arguing Germany bore primary responsibility for deliberately planning and provoking the war?	☐	☐	☐	
137	What clause of the 1919 Treaty of Versailles (Article 231) forced Germany to accept sole responsibility for causing the war?	☐	☐	☐	
138	Which naval rivalry fueled tension between Britain and Germany from 1898 to 1914, sparked by Admiral Tirpitz's Navy Laws and new all-big-gun battleships?	☐	☐	☐	
139	How do 'revisionist' historians such as Christopher Clark ('The Sleepwalkers') describe the outbreak of the First World War?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

1. 39
2. Prussia
3. Otto von Bismarck
4. Blood and iron
5. Warfare and military strength
6. Denmark, Austria, France
7. 1870
8. Palace of Versailles
9. 18 January 1871
10. Alsace-Lorraine
11. Zollverein
12. Austria
13. Kaiserreich
14. Seven weeks
15. Wilhelm I
16. To unite the southern German states with the north
17. Napoleon III
18. Coal and iron
19. It created long-term rivalry and hatred between France and Germany
20. A massive, powerful, militaristic state suddenly appeared in the center of Europe
21. France and Russia
22. A large group of states or countries ruled by a single monarch (emperor).
23. To defend against attacks from multiple sides (a two-front war).
24. A situation in which nations of the world have roughly equal power, preventing any one nation from dominating.
25. Otto von Bismarck
26. Ems Telegram
27. 1870
28. Alsace and Lorraine
29. Palace of Versailles
30. 5 billion francs
31. Kaiser Wilhelm II

- 32. Reinsurance Treaty**
- 33. France**
- 34. A two-front war**
- 35. Schlieffen Plan**
- 36. Napoleon III**
- 37. To unify the southern German states with the north**
- 38. Alsace-Lorraine**
- 39. Wilhelm I**
- 40. Editing the Ems Telegram**

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

41. He was captured along with his army
42. Treaty of Frankfurt
43. It would force Germany into a two-front war
44. The Hall of Mirrors at Versailles
45. The Scramble for Africa
46. Kaiser Wilhelm II
47. 1905
48. To regulate European colonization and trade in Africa
49. Britain
50. He wanted Germany to have a global empire like Britain and France
51. The Kaiser visited Tangier and declared support for Moroccan independence
52. Germany was humiliated and France was given control of Moroccan police
53. Germany sent the gunboat Panther to the port of Agadir
54. Germany backed down after being given a small strip of the Congo
55. It pushed Britain and France closer together in a strong alliance
56. Kaiser Wilhelm I
57. Otto von Bismarck
58. France
59. Alsace-Lorraine
60. Revanche

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

61. He edited the King's telegram to make it look like an insult to the French ambassador, forcing France to declare war out of pride.
62. Advanced railway networks for rapid mobilization and superior Krupp steel artillery.
63. It took place in the Hall of Mirrors at the Palace of Versailles, the historic heart of French royalty.
64. To keep France diplomatically isolated so they could never find an ally to help them fight a revenge war.
65. A two-front war against both France and Russia simultaneously.
66. HMS Dreadnought
67. Admiral von Tirpitz
68. Two-Power Standard
69. It was faster, heavier armored, and had all 'big-guns'
70. It made all older battleships instantly obsolete, resetting the naval race

71. Building a navy large enough that Britain wouldn't risk fighting it
72. 'We want eight and we won't wait!'
73. Britain is an island and relied entirely on its navy for survival and trade
74. The Naval Laws of 1898 and 1900
75. Britain, with 29 dreadnoughts to Germany's 17
76. It forced Britain out of 'Splendid Isolation' and into an alliance with France and Russia
77. Weltpolitik (World Policy)
78. By aggressively interfering, he terrified Britain into forming a closer military alliance with France.
79. It destroyed Bismarck's diplomatic safety net and threatened Germany with a two-front war.
80. It turned European empires into global rivals, causing constant friction and border disputes.

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

81. Britain realized it could no longer defend its empire alone and sought European allies.
82. His impulsive, aggressive nature alienated allies and destroyed Bismarck's careful diplomatic balance.
83. Kaiser Wilhelm II
84. Alsace-Lorraine
85. To keep France diplomatically isolated so they could never start a revenge war.
86. A two-front war against both France and Russia simultaneously.
87. Britain, France, Russia
88. Italy
89. Splendid Isolation
90. Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
91. Britain, France, Russia
92. A small dispute between two nations could drag all major powers into war
93. Because Kaiser Wilhelm II allowed the Reinsurance Treaty with Russia to lapse
94. A friendly agreement between Britain and France, settling colonial disputes
95. They felt threatened by Germany's growing navy and aggressive Weltpolitik
96. World policy (Germany's desire for a global empire)
97. Italy
98. HMS Dreadnought
99. A British policy stating their navy must be as large as the next two rival navies combined.
100. To protect their growing global trade and forcefully assert their status as a top-tier world power.

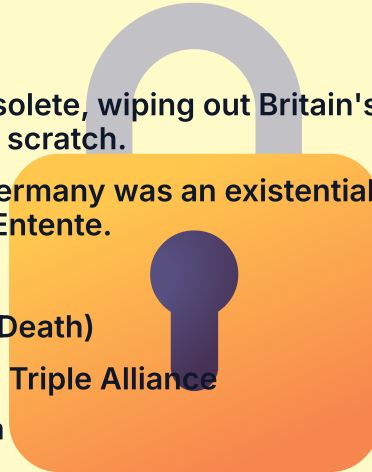
Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?

101. It rendered older ships obsolete, wiping out Britain's numerical lead and allowing Germany to compete from scratch.
102. We want eight, and we won't wait!
103. As an island nation, Britain relied on the sea to import food and defend its global empire.
104. It convinced Britain that Germany was an existential threat, cementing Britain's commitment to the Triple Entente.
105. Weltpolitik (World Policy)
106. By aggressively interfering, he terrified Britain into forming a closer military alliance with France.
107. It turned European empires into global rivals, causing constant friction and border disputes.

- 108. Gavrilo Princip
- 109. The Black Hand
- 110. 28 June 1914
- 111. Austria-Hungary
- 112. Archduke Franz Ferdinand
- 113. The Black Hand
- 114. A bomb was thrown at his car but bounced off
- 115. By total coincidence, the driver took a wrong turn and stalled the car right in front of him
- 116. Germany's promise of unconditional support to Austria-Hungary against Serbia
- 117. Austria-Hungary sent an impossibly harsh ultimatum to Serbia
- 118. Germany invaded neutral Belgium, violating the 1839 Treaty of London
- 119. Great Britain, France, and Russia
- 120. Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Italy

Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?

121. It was believed that the blocs were so heavily armed that attacking one would trigger an unwinnable global war, deterring aggression.
122. Nations felt trapped by their defensive commitments and constantly feared their rivals were plotting a sudden attack.
123. The Schlieffen Plan
124. Belgium
125. Encirclement
126. HMS Dreadnought
127. It rendered older ships obsolete, wiping out Britain's numerical lead and allowing Germany to compete from scratch.
128. It convinced Britain that Germany was an existential threat, cementing Britain's commitment to the Triple Entente.
129. Archduke Franz Ferdinand
130. The Black Hand (Union or Death)
131. The Triple Entente and the Triple Alliance
132. Britain, France, and Russia
133. The 'Blank Cheque'
134. The Schlieffen Plan
135. The Treaty of London
136. Fritz Fischer
137. The War Guilt Clause
138. The Dreadnought arms race
139. As a tragic breakdown of diplomacy where European leaders blindly sleepwalked into a catastrophe that none of them truly wanted or anticipated



Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 139 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/139)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			PARENT VALIDATION STAMP Effort: ★ ★ ★ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...